NERAI STRATEGIC INSIGHTS HUB

Chokepoint Pulse — Weekly Brief

Week of 16 October 2026 · auto-generated from open, licensed public data · updated every Friday

MARITIME CORRIDOR RISK — GDELT EVENT SCORES (0–100)

Corridor	Threat	Activity	Read
Strait of Hormuz	**65** Elevated	59	Mixed
Suez Canal	**61** Elevated	73	Act-driven
Red Sea / Bab-el-Mandeb	**60** Elevated	69	Act-driven
Eastern Mediterranean	**52** Watch	53	Mixed
Black Sea	**50** Watch	46	Mixed
Strait of Malacca	**48** Low-Medium	51	Mixed
South China Sea	**47** Low-Medium	49	Mixed
Taiwan Strait	**43** Low-Medium	45	Mixed

As of 2026-10-12. Media-derived event intensity for each corridor's coastal states (GDELT), scaled 0–100 against its own history. Not a transit count or freight rate.

STRAIT OF HORMUZ — RADAR VESSEL PRESENCE (SENTINEL-1)

30-day vessel presence vs 2025 baseline: **-35%** · shipping lanes -63% · last pass 2026-10-10 02:06 UTC.

Vessels detected in radar scenes per 1,000 km² of imaged water, against the 2025 median of the same orbit. Presence, not transits. Contains modified Copernicus Sentinel data 2025–2026.

ENERGY & COMMODITY BENCHMARKS — U.S. EIA SPOT · WORLD BANK PINK SHEET

Brent crude spot (FOB): **126.55** USD/bbl (+0.4% 7d) [2026-10-14]
WTI crude spot (Cushing): **101.91** USD/bbl (+7.3% 7d) [2026-10-14]
Henry Hub natural gas spot: **3.22** USD/MMBtu (+1.9% 7d) [2026-10-14]
Natural gas, Europe (monthly avg): **25.42** USD/MMBtu (+20.4% m/m) [2026-09]
Wheat, US HRW (monthly avg): **347.00** USD/mt (+5.2% m/m) [2026-09]
Maize (monthly avg): **239.60** USD/mt (+7.0% m/m) [2026-09]
Urea (monthly avg): **407.50** USD/mt (+4.5% m/m) [2026-09]

Source: U.S. Energy Information Administration (public domain) · World Bank Commodity Price Data (The Pink Sheet), CC BY 4.0.

GLOBAL SUPPLY CHAIN PRESSURE — NY FED GSCPI

GSCPI 2026-09: **+1.28** standard deviations from the historical average (previous +1.20).

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SANCTIONED FLEET — OFAC REGISTER

OFAC register: **1559** designated vessels (**847** tankers) · new designations since previous run: **0**.

Register counts from the OFAC Sanctions List Service. Vessel identity is matched only on IMO/MMSI.

TERMINAL CONTROL & LAND ALTERNATIVES — CHOKEPOINT WATCH AREAS

Red Sea · Suez · Bab el-Mandeb: land/rail alternatives Saudi Landbridge (planned), Ethiopia–Djibouti Railway; 4 tracked terminal operator(s) present, state-linked (High): DP World, China Merchants Port; (curated layer as of 2026-09-08)

Strait of Hormuz: land/rail alternatives UAE National Rail (Etihad Rail), Hafeet Rail (UAE–Oman); 4 tracked terminal operator(s) present, state-linked (High): DP World, PSA International, COSCO Shipping Ports; (curated layer as of 2026-09-08)

Black Sea · Bosphorus: land/rail alternatives EU–Ukraine Solidarity Lanes (rail legs), Türkiye Middle-Corridor leg; 2 tracked terminal operator(s) present, state-linked (High): DP World; (curated layer as of 2026-09-08)

Panama Canal: no curated land/rail alternative; 4 tracked terminal operator(s) present, state-linked (High): PSA International, COSCO Shipping Ports; (curated layer as of 2026-09-08)

Malacca · Singapore Strait: land/rail alternatives China–Europe Railway Express (CR Express), Middle Corridor / Trans-Caspian (TITR); 4 tracked terminal operator(s) present, state-linked (High): PSA International, COSCO Shipping Ports; (curated layer as of 2026-09-08)

Curated indicator-grade layers compiled from public operator/project disclosures; rail status as of last public information.

NAMED-HULL INCIDENT RECORD

DOWNY — Strike / permanently disabled (Gulf / Hormuz, 2026-09-05).

KYLO / NOXEN — Destroyed (Gulf / Hormuz, 2026-09-05).

SEAMULL (SIBU 1) — Piracy (Somalia / Gulf of Aden, 2026-08-20).

MINOAN DIGNITY — Conflict attack (Persian Gulf / Strait of Hormuz / Gulf of Oman, 2026-08-17).

Hull identifiers cross-referenced against the multi-jurisdiction vessel listing matrix; listing status reflects the register snapshot date.

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